

Spells

This section contains the spells available to investigators. Classical spells—those that have existed for centuries—each have a Latin name and may also have a colloquial “shorthand” name as well. Modern spells, such as those devised by Peter Grant, may have somewhat informal English names and completely lack a Latin name.

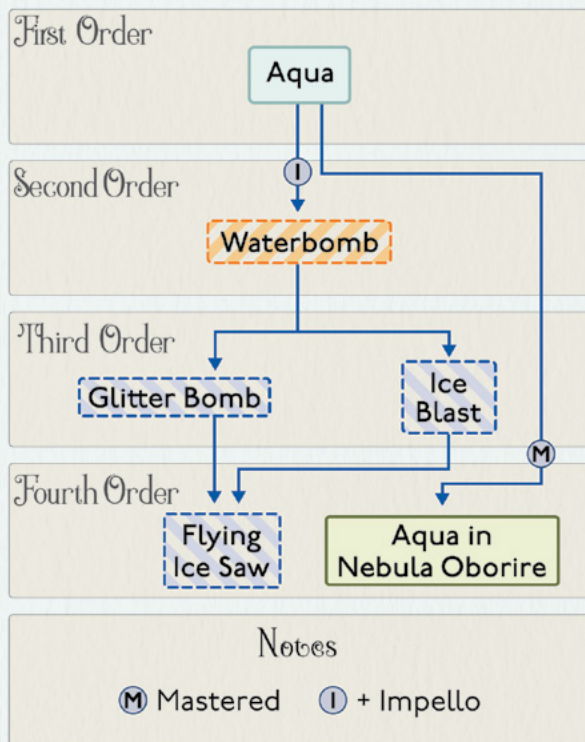
GM ADVICE

Remember: the base cost for a spell is equal to its order.

SPELL PREREQUISITES

As Newtonian spells consist of a sequence of *formae* strung together, certain spells have prerequisites, i.e., you cannot learn a particular spell unless you have first learned the spells containing the base *formae* that combine to form the spell. A spell’s prerequisites are listed in the spell’s description. Where a spell has no prerequisites, the entry reads “none.” An investigator cannot take a spell during character creation nor learn it during an **Investigator Development Phase** (page 120) unless they satisfy all of that spell’s prerequisites.

Aqua Spell Tree



FIRST ORDER SPELLS

Aqua

Prerequisite: none.

A simple *forma* used to generate a sphere of water the size of a ping-pong ball just above the caster’s palm. Useful if you need a source of water in a hurry.

Boost: spending more magic points increases the amount of water generated. Each additional point forms an additional ball of water or makes the existing ball of water larger.

It’s a lot like lux in that you shape the forma in your mind, open your palm and, hopefully, find yourself with a globe of water the size of a ping-pong ball.

—Broken Homes

Flash Bulb

Prerequisite: none.

Formerly known as *fulge*, this spell creates a bright flash of light. Can be used as a distraction or to temporarily blind someone. When cast in front of someone, the target must make a POW roll: if failed, they are stunned and partially blinded for 1D10 rounds. Targets blinded in this way lose their next action, and any actions that require sight are made with a penalty die while stunned.

The spell knocked her on her back, but she rolled, did something that I didn’t recognise, and a viciously bright flash in front of my face blinded me. I went crashing down to the cobbles. All I could see was a bruise-coloured blotch in front of my eyes.

—Lies Sleeping

Impello

Prerequisite: none.

Impello is a *forma* used to push, pull, or levitate objects. This is usually the second spell that a Newtonian apprentice is taught. One limitation of *Impello* is that the caster cannot lift themselves from the ground, not even by lifting something to which they are attached. The spell is useful for pushing an opponent back a metre/yard, thus potentially enabling a character to flee. If the target object is small, i.e., something you could conceal in one hand, the GM may ask for a successful POW roll to accurately target the object.

The effect of *Impello* is comparable to an invisible hand that can be used to push, pull, or lift a target. In a situation where the GM would call for a STR roll to test whether the character is strong enough to move an object, the GM should instead call for a POW roll. *Impello* could easily levitate an apple with no POW roll required, but if lifting or pushing something heavier, the GM should call for a POW roll. The difficulty level of the POW roll should be set by the

target's STR (**Determining the Difficulty Level**, page 105). Alternatively, if used against a character—rather than an inanimate object—the GM could call for an opposed POW vs STR roll (**Opposed Skill Rolls**, page 116).

Although the basic *Impello* spell isn't intended to inflict harm, it can cause damage, e.g., if the spellcaster successfully uses it to push an opponent down some stairs. If the use of *Impello* causes something to happen in the story that would obviously cause damage, the GM should refer to **Table 7: Other Forms of Damage** (page 149).

We sat down on opposite sides of the lab bench and Nightingale placed an object between us. It was a small apple. 'Impello,' he said, and the apple rose into the air. It hung there, rotating slowly, while I checked for wires, rods and anything else I could think of.
—*Rivers of London*

Noisemaker

Prerequisite: Werelight.

Creates a small cloud of gas that expands with a humorous farting noise, as well as making things shake (if the cloud is large enough). Useful for creating distractions if cast at a distance.

Now, I have the advantage over my nineteenth century peers of knowing what infrared is and how it relates to imparting heat energy to a small cloud of gas so that it expands with a humorous farting sound—oh, how they must have laughed.
—*The Hanging Tree*

Rock Drill

Prerequisite: *Impello*.

Creates a force powerful enough to break through rock or concrete. The power of the spell comes through bashing *Impello* repeatedly against the surface you want broken. The spell can break up 7.5 cm (3 inches) of concrete per round or 30 cm (1 foot) of compacted earth per round.

Boost: on each round following, 1 additional magic point can be spent to sustain the spell.

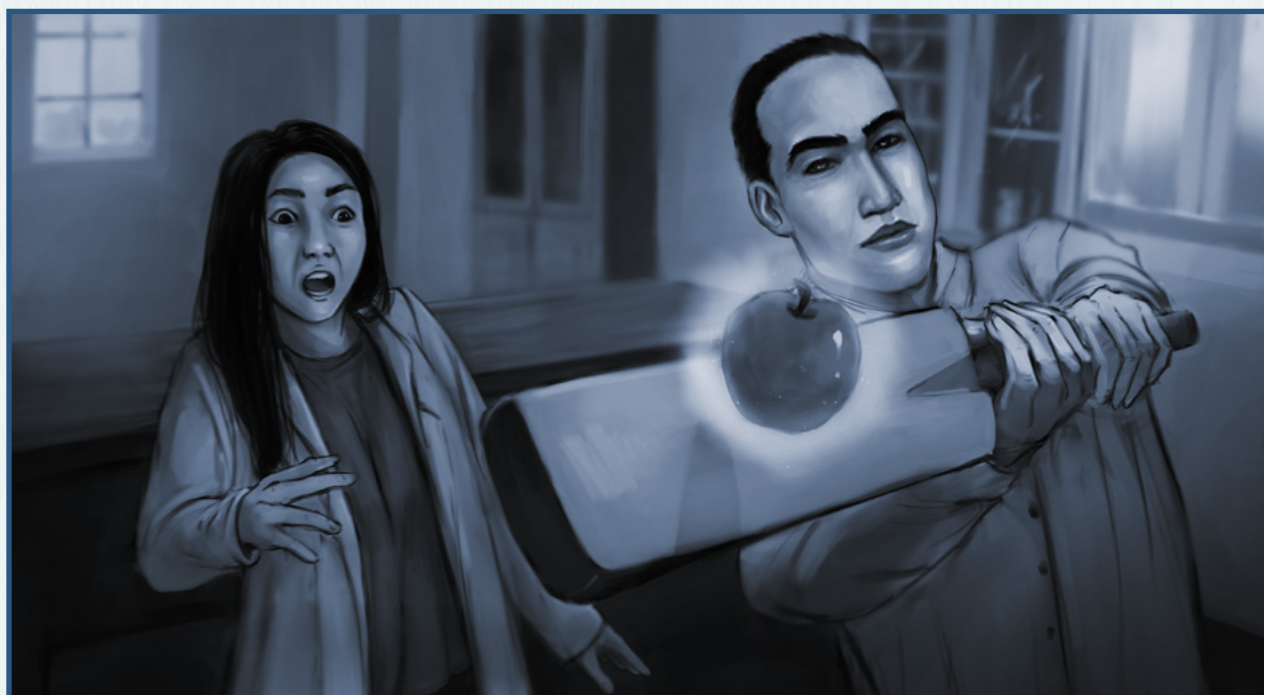
You don't make an invisible pneumatic drill by picturing it in your mind. You do it by shaping the correct variation of impello, lining it up in the right direction and then essentially turning it on and off as fast as you can.

—*Whispers Under Ground*

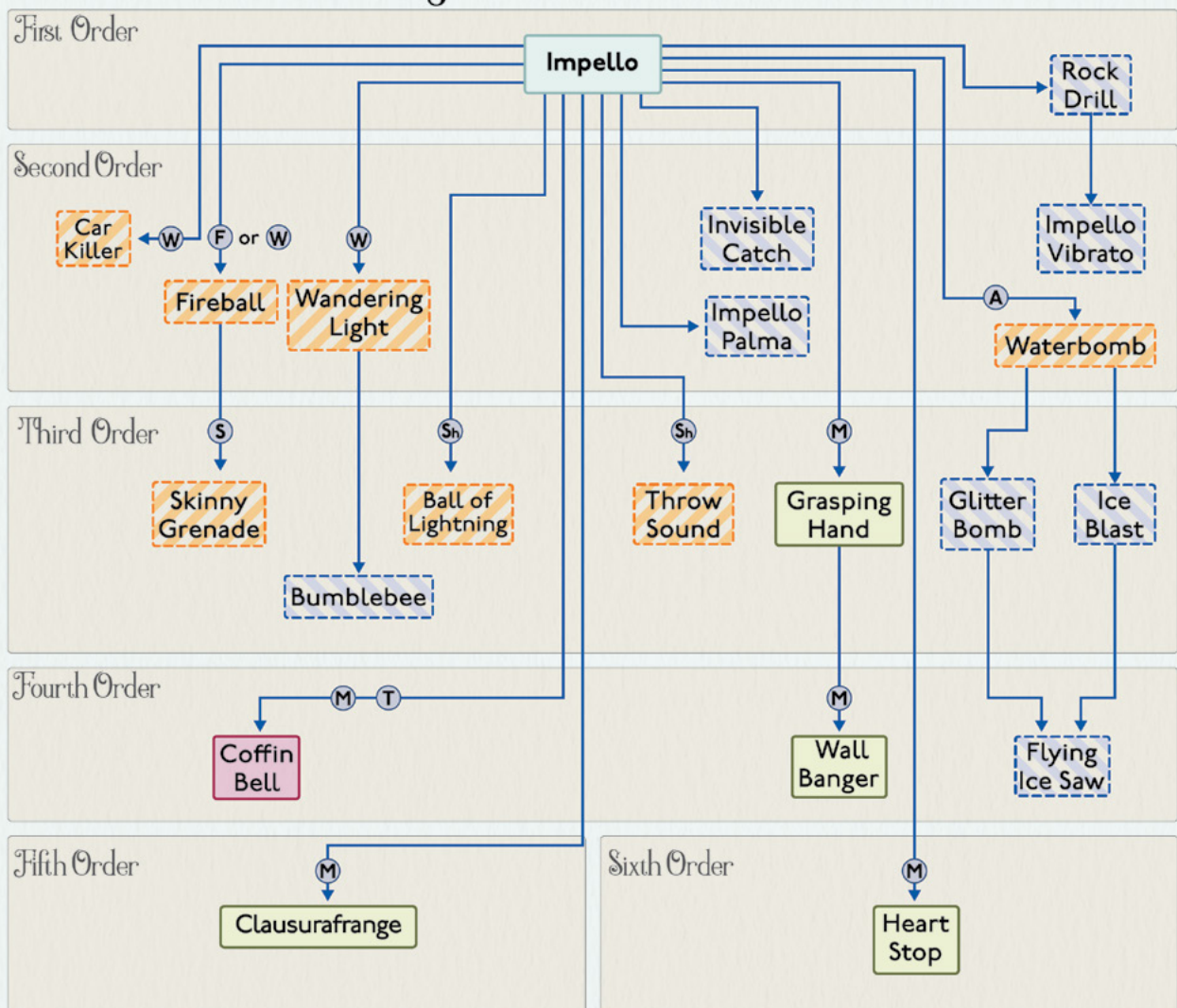
Scindere

Prerequisite: none.

The effect of *Scindere* is comparable to an invisible hand used to hold an object stationary. *Scindere* can hold something up to the size of a large watermelon (approx. 10kg/22lbs). An opposed STR vs POW (of the caster) roll would be required if someone was attempting to move something held in place with *Scindere*. If someone wishes to use magic to move an object held by *Scindere* (such as using *Impello* vs *Scindere*), the GM should call for an opposed POW roll between the two spellcasters to determine who triumphs (**Impello**, page 178).

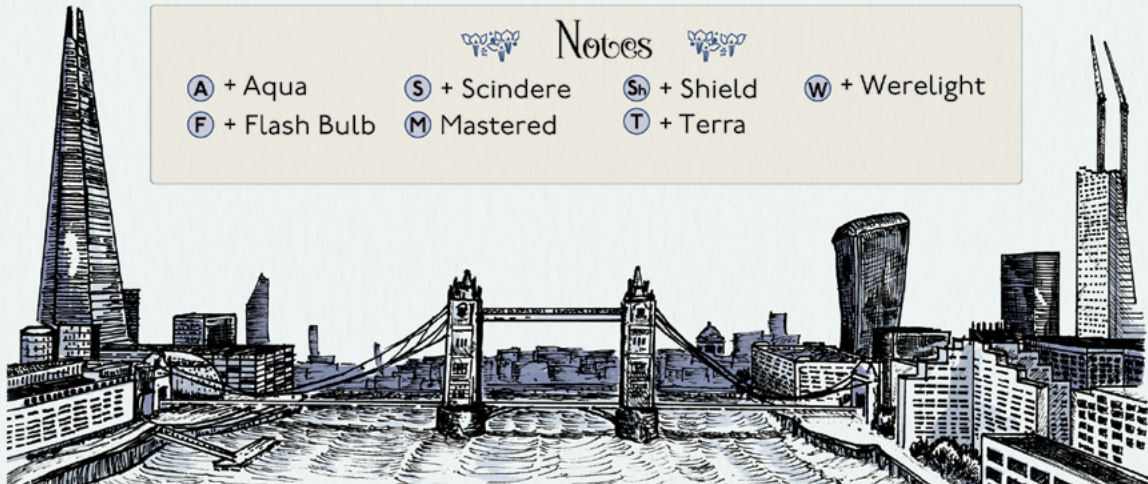


Impello Spell Tree



Notes

- (A) + Aqua
- (S) + Scindere
- (Sh) + Shield
- (W) + Werelight
- (F) + Flash Bulb
- (M) Mastered
- (T) + Terra



Boost: the base cost permits the caster to hold objects up to the size of a large watermelon. Boosting the spell with additional points increases the weight of what can be lifted or held in place. Instead of dealing with precise weights, the game uses objects to provide a sense of what can be achieved:

- ◆ **+1 magic point** (total cost of 2 magic points): increases the amount that can be lifted/held to that of any human being.
- ◆ **+2 magic points** (total cost of 3 magic points): increases the amount that can be lifted/held to that of any horse or cow.
- ◆ **+3 magic points** (total cost of 4 magic points): increases the amount that can be lifted/held to that of an average car, and so on.
- ◆ Prior to the end of the spell's duration, 1 additional magic point can be spent to sustain the spell for another 5 minutes.

The first time Nightingale demonstrated the forma, I'd asked how long the apples would stay fixed in place. He'd said that it depended on how much magic the apple had been imbued with.

—Moon Over Soho

Snapdragon

Prerequisite: none.

Produces a flash and a loud crack that can be used to cause a distraction or scare. Not originally Newtonian, but now adopted into the roster.

'She'd already taught me the snapdragon by the time I was seven,' said Lady Helena. Nightingale asked for a demonstration; she made a flicking gesture with her hand and there was a flash and a loud crack that echoed off the walls and caused Molly to suddenly appear behind Nightingale's chair.

—The Hanging Tree

Terra

Prerequisite: none.

Generates a small golf-ball-sized rock or handful of earth. One of the basic forms, producing similar effects to those achieved by the **Quiet People** (page 253). Useful if you need rocks to throw or if you need earth to smother a fire.

Boost: spending more magic points increases the amount of earth or rock generated. Each additional point forms an additional ball or makes the existing ball/handful larger.

It [aqua] used to form the empedoclean along with lux, aer and terra—two of which went out of fashion when the four-element theory of matter failed to survive the age of Enlightenment.

—Broken Homes

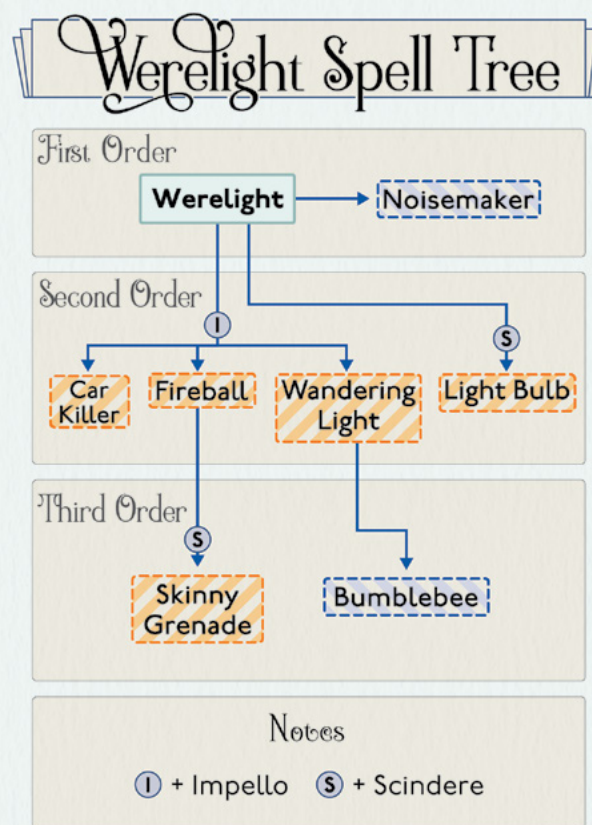
Werelight

Prerequisite: none.

Generates a small ball of bright light about the size of a golf ball with the brightness of a domestic lightbulb. The standard werelight gives off no heat. Werelights do not usually move of their own volition, but while on the caster's hand, they move with it, or the caster can position them in a static location. See **Light Bulb** (page 184) and **Bumblebee** (page 186) for mobile variations of the Werelight spell. A werelight lasts for 5 minutes.

Boost: spending 1 additional magic point increases the brightness of the light created or generates an additional ball. Boosted with one magic point, the light is so intense that it is painful to look at, and could illuminate a large hall. Prior to the end of the spell's duration, 1 additional magic point can be spent to sustain the spell for another 5 minutes.

Ghosts are drawn to the magical energy of a werelight, and they enjoy feeding from it. While a ghost feeds, the werelight's colour slowly changes from a soft white/milky blue to yellow to red/dark crimson; the ghost becomes visible and is likely to converse with the caster.



Mastered: change the brightness of the light (sort of like a domestic lightbulb on a dimmer switch). The caster can also change the werelight's colour, even shifting down the spectrum to something barely visible. Cast at a very low power, the werelight produces a soft glow without blowing nearby microprocessors. It can also be modified to go beyond the range of visible light and into infrared, thus creating heat.

I have a nice low powered werelight that I can conjure in an interview room without blowing all the surveillance—you'd be amazed how often I have to use it. My latest refinement was to add a scindere forma so that I can park it over my shoulder and use it as a reading light.

—The Hanging Tree

SECOND ORDER SPELLS

Candano

Prerequisite: none.

Also known as Tanglefoot, from the Greek (*kbandánō*), this spell creates a magical bolo that wraps around a person's lower legs and ankles. An effective way to prevent someone from running away and/or to trip them up.

In combat, the spell's attack is resolved in the same manner as a firearms attack (**Combat**, page 123), with the attack roll (Firearms) replaced by the spellcasting roll (Magic). If the spell is cast successfully, its target is permitted a DEX or STR roll (whichever is higher). With a Hard success, the target avoids becoming entangled by the bolo or breaks free from it. Otherwise, the target's legs become entangled for 2 rounds; if they attempt to move, they fall over and become prone (**Combat Manoeuvres**, page 134). However, the target cannot stand up again on their turn as a free action until the spell ends. Attacks against a prone character gain a bonus die.

Car Killer

Prerequisites: Werelight + *Impello*.

Magic has the side effect of frying microprocessors (**Spells and Technology**, page 176) and thus modern vehicles can be disabled with a single well-placed spell. The spell's title is "Car Killer," but the spell can be used to disable any piece of modern technology containing a microprocessor.

And once you've quantified an effect, it becomes that much easier to weaponize it. All you need to do is modify your werelight a bit with a couple of formae inflectentes and, after about three weeks of trial and error, you have a projectable spell that will burn out every microprocessor within a conveniently small radius.

—Foxglove Summer

Fireball

Prerequisites: *Impello* + Werelight or Flash Bulb.

Uses the *forma lux* (light) coupled with *iactus* (an *adjectivum*) and *impello* (to move it about), to create the classic fireball. The spell can vary widely in magnitude. This is typically a loud and flashy spell, causing a sudden flash of light and sounding like a bedsheet being ripped in half. The resulting fireball is, however, a relatively slow projectile and can be stopped by modern ballistic armour.

In combat, the spell's attack is resolved in the same manner as a firearms attack (**Combat**, page 123), with the attack roll (Firearms) replaced by the spellcasting roll (Magic). A damage roll should be made using the caster's DEX. The basic spell inflicts 1 weapon damage, which is added to the result of the damage roll, if applicable (**The Damage Roll**, page 132).

Boost: each additional magic point can be used to increase the spell's damage by +1. The attacker can choose to describe this as a single larger fireball or an additional fireball; the result is the same.

Mastered: the size of the fireballs can be altered. Narrow-gauge fireballs can be used to disguise the method of attack, creating wounds that look more like those of a handgun.

'You didn't say the Latin,' I pointed out.

'You practise this in silence,' he said, 'from the outset. This spell is a weapon. It has a single purpose and that is to kill. Once you've mastered it you are under the same obligations as any other armed constable, so I suggest you familiarise yourself with the current guidelines on firearms use.'

—Rivers of London

Impello Palma

Prerequisite: *Impello*.

Creates an invisible hand-like force that can be used to swat at objects and people, such as knocking a book out of someone's hands or slapping a person across the face. Often deployed as a non-lethal means of delaying or distracting someone.

If used in combat, the spell is an attack and is resolved exactly the same as a firearms attack (**Combat**, page 123), with the attack roll (Firearms) replaced by the spellcasting roll (Magic). If successful, it inflicts 1 damage total.

Boost: additional magic points can turn the invisible force into a temporary barrier that lasts as long as the caster maintains their concentration or 5 minutes, whichever occurs first. There are two ways another person may attempt to push through the invisible barrier:

- ♦ If trying to run and force their way through the barrier: ineffective—it's like bouncing off a plate-glass window; the person suffers 1 damage.
- ♦ If trying to slowly and deliberately push their way through the barrier: it's like walking through treacle/molasses, but if the person succeeds with an opposed POW roll versus the caster, they pass through unharmed; if failed, they cannot pass through.
- ♦ **+1 magic point** (total cost of 3 magic points): creates a barrier the size of typical single door.
- ♦ **+2 magic points** (total cost of 4 magic points): doubles the size of the barrier (e.g., a double door).

Note: this barrier does not protect against damage; for that, see **Shield (Basic)** (page 185).

I didn't give him a chance to finish the movement—I made the formae in my head, flung out my left hand, still holding my phone, and shouted, much louder than I'm supposed to, 'Impello palma.'
—Whispers Under Ground

Impello Vibrato

Prerequisite: Rock Drill.

A subtler and more advanced version of **Rock Drill** (page 180). Can be used to cause matter to vibrate, making it useful for making out of reach objects fall over or fall off a surface on which they're resting, all the way up to causing a structure to collapse or crumble. It can only be used to vibrate inert matter such as earth, brick, or concrete. This spell is unusual as it requires the spellcaster to concentrate for three or five rounds; this means they can undertake no other actions while the spell is performed. If the caster is injured or otherwise caused to be distracted, the caster should make a POW roll to determine if the *Impello vibrato* spell is disrupted (fails).

The effect is like someone hitting the targeted area with an invisible, silent hammer. The GM must figure out what effect this might have: a hammer could break a ceramic or glass object or knock out the load-bearing bricks of a chimney, while a sledgehammer (see **Boost**) could destroy a wall or cause a larger structure to fail. If aiming to collapse a structure, e.g., a chimney, the entire structure need not be vibrated, just the critical load-bearing parts—a successful INT roll prior to use allows the caster to target the spell efficiently to minimise their magic expenditure. The spell has no visible effect until the caster ends the spell.

To collapse a structure where the spell has been targeted with a successful INT roll requires three rounds. The structure collapses immediately after the caster's turn in the third round is over. When the spell hasn't been targeted with a successful INT roll, it takes five rounds to push the weakened structure over.

Boost: spending 2 additional magic points upgrades the invisible, silent hammer to a sledgehammer.

I'd been working on loosening up the chimney stack with what I call Impello vibrato but which Nightingale calls will you stop messing about and pay attention, while Faceless had been chatting.
—Moon Over Soho

Invisible Catch

Prerequisite: *Impello*.

Combining *Impello* with *iactus* (an *adjectivum*) allows the caster to catch objects in mid-air. It can be used upon living or non-living objects. If the target object is moving quickly (such as if thrown), the casting roll must be made with a penalty die (as per **Fast-Moving Targets**, page 138).

The effect of Invisible Catch is comparable to an invisible hand. In a situation where the GM would call for a STR roll to test whether the character is strong enough to catch an object, the GM should instead call for a POW roll. The spell could easily catch an apple with no POW roll required, but if catching something heavier, such as a child falling from an upstairs window, the GM should call for a POW roll. The spell can be used to catch other magical effects, such as fireballs (see **Boost**). It cannot catch bullets—they're way too fast.

Boost: for the spell to be powerful enough to hold an incoming projectile, such as a thrown weapon, heavy object, or fireball—but not a bullet—the total number of magic points spent must equal or exceed the damage the projectile would otherwise inflict.

So I shot him. It was worth it just for the obvious outrage it caused him, and I enjoyed it right up until the point where he caught the bloody fireball. Just snatched it out of the air and held it, Yorick-like, in front of his face.

—Moon Over Soho

Light Bulb

Prerequisites: *Scindere* + Werelight.

Uses *lux iactus scindere* to fix a werelight in position to provide light. Those who don't know any better would mistake this for a standard light fitting. This spell combines features of the **Werelight** spell (page 182) and **Scindere** spell (page 180), and is fixed in a location chosen by the caster. The light lasts for 5 minutes.

Boost: each additional magic point spent allows the caster to increase either the size or the brightness of the light created. Prior to the end of the spell's duration, 1 additional magic point can be spent to sustain the spell for another 5 minutes.

Note: if the caster wishes to fix the werelight in a position they cannot physically reach, they must combine this spell with **Impello** (page 178) to manoeuvre the werelight into position. This combined version of the spell is third order and has a base cost of 3 magic points; it can be boosted as described above.

I fixed the werelight to the ceiling with scindare in the hope that Reynolds would mistake it for a light fixture...
—Whispers Under Ground

Serra Obscura

Prerequisite: Shield.

Creates a small force blade up to 6 cm (2.4 inches) in length, which extends from the caster's palm, thumb, or finger (caster's choice). The blade can be used to cut through rope or other materials, or can be used as a melee weapon. The blade lasts for 1 minute (or the equivalent of 6 combat rounds). If used as a weapon in combat, attacks are made using the wielder's Fighting skill, as per non-magical melee weapons. The blade has a base damage of 1.

While they were chatting, I created a little shield and, very carefully, sliced off the ropes around my wrist.
—Foxglove Summer

Shield (Basic)

Prerequisite: none.

Uses *aer conglare* to control the air in front of the caster, allowing them to form a shield that's capable of stopping bullets—or, at least, slowing them down dramatically. It's also rather handy at protecting against melee weapons and fists.

Each firearms attack should be resolved in the usual way (**Combat**, page 123), with the result of the damage roll reduced by the shield. The spell reduces the damage inflicted by an attack (or each bullet) by 2, and can withstand a total of ten times that number, i.e., once the shield has absorbed a total of 20 points of damage, it fails. The Shield spell also stacks with **Armour** (page 135).

Boost: each additional magic point spent allows the caster to choose one of the following:

- ♦ Fix the shield in place.
- ♦ Increase the defensive value of the shield, reducing the incoming damage by a further 1 (meaning 1 additional point would reduce damage by 3, and withstand a total of 30 damage, and so on).

On each following round, 1 additional magic point can be spent to sustain the spell, adding another 10 points to the total damage the shield can withstand.

Mastered: can be cast at an angle to deflect projectiles hitting it. This increases the amount of damage the shield can withstand from ten times to 20 times, so the basic spell can withstand a total of 40 damage before failing.

Nightingale took the trouble to teach me aer because, combined with the equally tricky and out-of-fashion conglare, it creates a shield in front of my body.
—Whispers Under Ground

Wandering Light

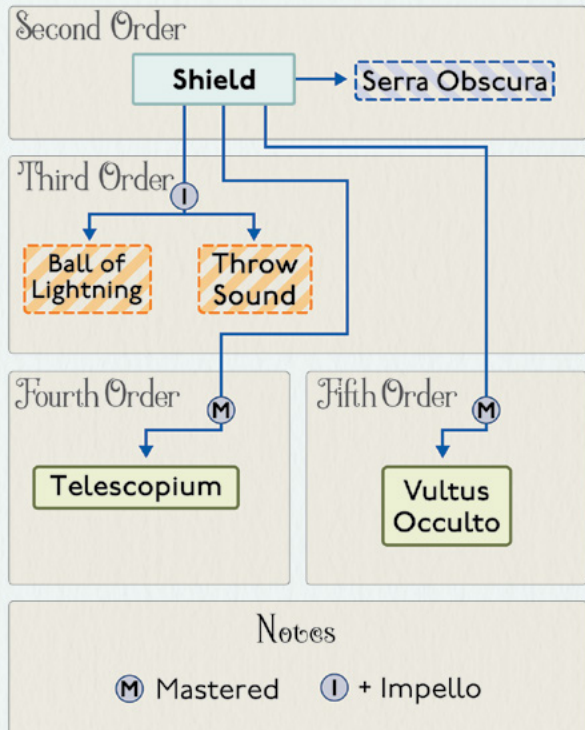
Prerequisites: *Impello* + Werelight.

Uses *lux impello* to create a werelight that bobs along with the caster in a fixed position. The light could be behind you, to the side, in front, or above. The light lasts 5 minutes.

Boost: each additional magic point spent allows the caster to increase either the size or the brightness of the light created. Prior to the end of the spell's duration, 1 additional magic point can be spent to sustain the spell for another 5 minutes.

I cast a simple lux impello combo which put a yellowish werelight about two metres over my head where, hopefully, it would bob about after me like a balloon, only brightly lit.
—Foxglove Summer

Shield Spell Tree



Waterbomb

Prerequisites: *Aqua* + *Impello*.

Causes a balloon-sized ball of water to appear where the caster directs.

Boost: each additional magic point spent allows the caster to choose one of the following:

- ♦ Propel the balloon to hit a target.
- ♦ Cause the water to be chilled.

While this spell causes no harm, it can cause a distraction. Anyone struck by the spell must make a POW roll, with a penalty die if the water is chilled. Those failing the POW roll lose their next action and must apply a penalty die to any roll made as their next action.

I flicked a water bomb into his face—a nice cold one, thanks to a trick Varvara taught me—and followed up by kicking him in the bollocks. He gave me a puzzled look and then fell flat on his face.

—Lies Sleeping

THIRD ORDER SPELLS

Ball of Lightning

Prerequisites: *Impello* + *Shield*.

Creates a fist-sized ball of lightning that propels itself at a target. Like an advanced fireball, but based on the use of *aer* rather than *lux*. The spell's attack is resolved in the same manner as a firearms attack (**Combat**, page 123), with the attack roll (Firearms) replaced by the spellcasting roll (Magic). A damage roll should be made using the caster's DEX. The basic spell inflicts 2 weapon damage, which is added to the result of the damage roll, if applicable (**The Damage Roll**, page 132).

Boost: each additional magic point spent increases the power of the spell by +1 weapon damage.

Just in time, because a fist-sized ball of lightning struck it at chest height and exploded—half blinding me.

—The October Man

Bumblebee

Prerequisite: *Wandering Light*.

Generates a golf-ball-sized orangey-red sphere that flies about erratically for a few rounds, making a distinctive squealing sound as it bounces around. It is apt to shoot off the wrong way first before returning to the caster and then flitting about in the direction it was supposed to go. It doesn't do much, other than create a hard-to-ignore distraction.

The basis is your bog-standard lux-impello combination—the complications come in the various modifiers you add to the principal formae. I opened my hand and an orangey-red sphere the size of a golf ball immediately shot back down the tunnel the way we'd come.

‘Ah,’ said Nightingale.

‘It always does that,’ I said. ‘Wait a second.’

—Lies Sleeping

Glitter Bomb

Prerequisite: *Waterbomb*.

An icy projectile is generated and thrown at a target causing an area to freeze. The name of the spell evokes the light reflecting from the ice crystals that form where the spell hits. A wave of cool air flows outward from the point of impact. Those caught within the blast radius of the spell may suffer damage. The radius of the spell is 2 metres/yards.

The spell's attack is resolved exactly the same as a firearms attack (**Combat**, page 123), with the attack roll (Firearms) replaced by the spellcasting roll (Magic). A damage roll should be made using the caster's DEX. The basic spell inflicts 2 weapon damage, which is added to the result of the damage roll, if applicable (**The Damage Roll**, page 132).

Boost: each additional magic point increases the radius by 1 metre/yard.

This was one of Varvara's wartime spells as translated by Abigail—Ledyanaya Bomba in Russian, but we call it a glitter bomb because of the way light sparkles off the ice crystals that form around the epicentre.

—Lies Sleeping

Grasping Hand

Prerequisite: *Impello* (mastered).

A more complex version of the first order *Impello*, allowing the caster to grasp and move structures with superhuman strength. This version of the spell is designed to cause damage and is very handy for pulling off car doors!

The effects are hard to quantify precisely but, as a guide, the standard spell allows the caster to rip a locked car door off by its hinges or roll an object like a standard car onto its roof without the need for a STR roll. Enterprising burglars could use it to rip locked doors out of their frames, should the mood take them.

While not intended for deployment against the living, if the spell is used against people or creatures, they are picked up and flung with considerable force a number of metres/yards equal to the caster's POW; refer to **Table 7: Other Forms of Damage** (page 149). The standard spell inflicts Severe damage.

Boost: each additional magic point spent increases the size of object that can be damaged or rolled by this spell.

- ♦ **+1 magic point** (total cost of 4 magic points): roll a large vehicle (heavy car or pickup truck); causes Deadly damage if used against living creatures.
- ♦ **+2 magic points** (total cost of 5 magic points): roll a delivery truck; causes Terminal damage if used against living creatures.
- ♦ **+3 magic points** (total cost of 6 magic points): roll an articulated lorry or rip the door off a bank vault; causes Splat damage if used against a living creature.

I made it into my own gap between a BMW 5 series and a Jaguar XJ, whose resale value Lesley had recently lowered by ripping open the doors, just before a chunk of the ceiling collapsed onto the spot where I'd been lying.

—*The Hanging Tree*

Ice Blast

Prerequisite: Waterbomb.

An attack spell creating a blast of freezing ice particles of varying sizes. The effect spreads forward from the caster's hand in a conical shape, extending 30 metres/yards. At the caster's end, the cone is only a hand's width in size, but, at the far end, the effect is 3 metres/yards wide. Anyone in the line of the blast may suffer damage.

The spell's attack is resolved exactly the same as a firearms attack (**Combat**, page 123), with the attack roll (Firearms) replaced by the spellcasting roll (Magic). A damage roll should be made using the caster's DEX. The basic spell inflicts 2 weapon damage, which is added to the result of the damage roll, if applicable (**The Damage Roll**, page 132). Armour has no effect versus Ice Blast.

Boost: each additional magic point spent increases the power of the spell by +1 weapon damage.

It saved my life, because the next instant I was struck by a freight train full of icicles.

—*Broken Homes*

Skinny Grenade

Prerequisites: Fireball + *Scindere*.

Lux impello scindere creates a projectile that sticks to its target before exploding a few seconds later—although sometimes it can take more than a minute. In effect, a skinny grenade is a delayed-action fireball, with a blast radius of 2 metres/yards.

The spell's attack is resolved exactly the same as a firearms attack (**Combat**, page 123), with the attack roll (Firearms) replaced by the spellcasting roll (Magic). Roll 1D10 to determine how many rounds it takes for the skinny grenade

to explode (there is always a delay between casting and the skinny grenade exploding), and then make a damage roll using the caster's DEX. The standard spell inflicts 1 weapon damage, which is added to the result of the damage roll, if applicable (**The Damage Roll**, page 132).

Boost: each additional magic point spent increases the power of the spell by +1 weapon damage.

Mastered: the delay between casting and exploding is dictated by the caster (choose from 1–10 rounds).

'Skinny grenade,' I said. 'You use Scindere like you do with Lux impello scindere, except instead of a light in a fixed place you get a bomb.'

'Skinny grenade?'

'From Scindere,' I said. Nightingale shook his head.

—*Moon Over Soho*

Throw Sound

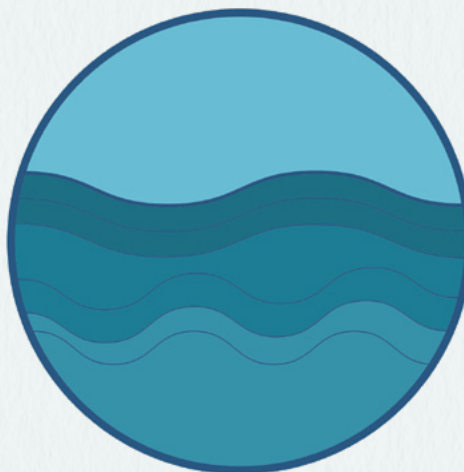
Prerequisites: Shield + *Impello*.

Allows the caster to throw their own voice, making it seem as if it is coming from elsewhere in the vicinity. The spell uses the *aer forma* and various *inflectentes* to create a sound. Another useful spell for creating a distraction.

Boost: spending 1 additional magic point allows the caster to create sounds other than their own voice, such as the barking of a dog or the sound of a car.

I noticed then that Nightingale's Jag, which I swore I'd heard pull up in front of the barn, was nowhere to be seen.

—*Broken Homes*



FOURTH ORDER SPELLS

Aqua in Nebula Oborire

Prerequisite: *Aqua* (mastered).

Created by a mountebank in the Folly's wild pre-respectable days, this spell raises a mist from a body of water by exciting the water molecules on the surface, but only enough to form a mist in whatever atmospheric conditions prevail—not that the creator of this spell knew that! A moderately difficult spell that some claim only exists to make spectators murmur “Ooooooh!”, it can be used for nefarious purposes with a little planning aforethought.

Once the spell has been cast on a suitably large body of water—at minimum, a large duck pond or a small lake—a mist gradually begins to gather. It takes five minutes for there to be enough mist to roll off the water and form an oddly warm wall of water vapour 100 metres/yards in diameter—sufficient to hide in. While in the mist, investigators gain a bonus die on Stealth rolls and incur a penalty die on Observation rolls, e.g., when attempting to spot other people moving through the mist. The mist rapidly dissipates after 15 minutes.

Coffin Bell, The

Prerequisites: *Terra* (mastered) + *Impello* (mastered).

Moves 2 cubic metres/yards of earth or debris. Especially useful if one finds oneself buried alive—hence the spell's name.

Boost: each additional magic point spent increases the amount of earth moved by +1 cubic metre/yard.

There's a spell that dates back to the Victorian era called the coffin bell, designed to allow a skilled practitioner to dig himself out from his own grave. It's a fourth order spell, so I reckon you'd have to be a pretty good practitioner to be able to cast it after being accidentally buried alive. I also have doubts about whether it could shift four cubic metres of loose earth, but it certainly made short work of the pile of office furniture I was under.

—False Value

Flying Ice Saw

Prerequisites: Glitter Bomb or Ice Blast.

Creates a large disk, 3 metres/yards across, that spins like a circular saw blade or drill head. The blade moves at speed through the air, slicing through whatever it contacts. As it moves, it emits a loud humming sound. The disk inflicts damage on anything it hits. It lasts for one round and can be used to attack 3 separate targets, as long as they are within 10 metres/yards of each other.



The spell's attack is resolved exactly the same as a firearms attack (**Combat**, page 123), with the attack roll (Firearms) replaced by the spellcasting roll (Magic). A damage roll should be made using the caster's DEX. The basic spell inflicts 2 weapon damage, which is added to the result of the damage roll, if applicable (**The Damage Roll**, page 132).

Boost: each additional magic point spent increases the power of the spell by +1 weapon damage.

I only saw it coming because of the rain from the sprinklers. It was like a lens, an optical distortion whirling through the air—a circular saw three metres across, droplets spraying off the top. Even as I was dropping I saw it slice horizontally through the front of the Humvee. And it was fast.

—*The Hanging Tree*

Natchaduri

Prerequisite: *Candano*.

Also known as Dancing Rope, this spell creates a braid of crimson smoke that can be used to bind, slap, or pummel someone or something up to 15 metres/yards away. The name is an anglicisation of the Bengali নাচের দড়ি (*Nācēra daṛi*).

Natchaduri acts like a whip, and can be used in one of two ways: to perform a **Combat Manoeuvre** (page 134), such as entangling a person or knocking something from their hand, or to inflict harm. The *natchaduri* lasts for 2 rounds, but the caster is limited to performing one action with it (combat manoeuvre or harm).

In combat, the spell's attack is resolved in the same manner as a firearms attack (**Combat**, page 123), with the attack roll (Firearms) replaced by the spellcasting roll (Magic). If used to bind, the target is permitted a DEX or STR roll (whichever is higher). With a Hard success the target avoids becoming entangled or breaks free; otherwise, they remain bound for 4 rounds. If used to harm, any damage roll should be made using the caster's DEX. The spell inflicts 1 weapon damage, which is added to the result of the damage roll, if applicable (**The Damage Roll**, page 132).

Using the "rope" for climbing is a challenge as it is short-lived and must be affixed to something. Depending on the situation, the GM may call for a DEX roll to anchor the "rope," followed by a Hard Athletics roll to scale the "rope" before it dissipates.

Telescopium

Prerequisite: Shield (mastered).

Manipulates the air in front of the caster to create two lenses, bending light to create the effect of a telescope. Similar in essence to the shield spell, using two carefully aligned mini-shields to distort and focus light.

Newton's spell used the aer forma to grab hold of the air in front of your face and then craft it into two lenses that act like a telescope. The great man called it telescopium, which tells you everything you need to know about his approach to branding. Beyond the usual drawbacks—i.e., the risk of having your brain turn into a diseased cauliflower—if the lenses are the wrong shape you get a face full of rainbows. And if you're stupid enough to look at the sun you can make yourself permanently blind.

—*Broken Homes*

Wall Banger, The

Prerequisite: Grasping Hand (mastered).

Rips apart architecture, unzipping brickwork and syphoning it up into the air only to deposit it unceremoniously somewhere nearby. The effect is powerful enough to pull apart one face of an average house—bricks, doors, windows, and all—and drop the resulting rubble into two big piles on either side. The spell uses a variant of the *impello forma* along with *temperāre* and some other complicated twists.

Boost: for every 2 additional magic points spent, an extra amount of wall of similar size is ripped apart.

Then the front of the barn literally unzipped—bricks fountaining up and away in two diverging streams and the doors abruptly ripped off their hinges and went spinning off through the air like something from a catastrophic decompression.

—*Broken Homes*



FIFTH ORDER SPELLS

Clausurafrange

Prerequisite: *Impello* (mastered).

Used to deal with locks with varying degrees of subtlety. The caster must be close to the target lock. A successful casting unlocks any mundane—i.e., non-magical—lock. If the caster has plenty of time—and skill—this spell neatly “drills” the lock. If you’re in a hurry, you can use it to pop the lock right out of its frame.

Boost: spending 1 additional magic point allows the caster to very neatly pick the lock, leaving it undamaged.

I was working to perfect my first fifth order spell, clausurafrange, which was supposed to neatly pop out a lock but was currently just making damp holes in the riverbank...

—False Value

Seducere

Prerequisite: none.

Grants the ability to bend a single target to the caster’s will, with an effect similar to the *genii locorum*’s **Glamour** (page 243). The single target of the spell may be compelled to do anything from fetching something useful through to performing a dangerous act that could harm themselves or others. The spell works by causing a biochemical reaction, releasing hormones—serotonin, etc.—into the target’s system. As a fifth order spell, *Seducere* costs 5 magic points, but its effects are limited to one animal, such as a single dog. It may be boosted to affect a single human.

When *Seducere* is used upon a target, they are permitted a POW roll to resist its effects. If targeting animals or non-practitioners, the outcomes of the POW roll are as follows:

- ♦ **Fumble or failure:** they do as they are bid without question, nor do they ever think to question why they acted as they did.
- ♦ **Regular or Hard success:** they do as they are bid without question, but later they perhaps wonder what possessed them to act as they did. Of course, they soon console themselves with any excuse that feels the most rational to them.
- ♦ **Critical success:** they are unaffected by the spell and react to the request as though it were asked by another person. They are not aware of anything magical having taken place.

GM ADVICE

Whether the target is aware of the spell or not, if it’s an investigator, they can spend Luck to overcome a failed POW roll (**Spending Luck**, page 113). The player could also choose to push the roll—represented by them struggling to maintain their self-control and resist the compulsion, just as Peter Grant does when facing Lady Ty’s actual glamour⁴—though a second failure would leave the investigator completely at the caster’s mercy.



Important: Consent

Certain spells, such as *Seducere* and *Vox imperante* involve compelling a character to behave in a certain way if they fail to resist the spell’s effects. The GM and players should discuss the boundaries of what that entails for their group and set limits accordingly to ensure that no one is ever made to feel uncomfortable or unsafe out of character through those spells’ usage.

Whereas, if targeting a practitioner or someone aware of the glamour, the outcomes of the POW roll are as follows:

- ♦ **Fumble:** they behave exactly as bidden. They are unaware of the use of the spell.
- ♦ **Failure:** they begin to act as requested, perhaps taking a few steps or speaking a few words, but then recover their self-control. They are aware of the use of the spell.
- ♦ **Any level of success:** they are aware of the use of *Seducere*, but are not compelled to act upon it.

Boost: spending 2 additional magic points extends the effect to a single human being.

‘Seducere,’ he said. ‘The Compulsion, or, as the Scots say, “the Glamour”. According to Bartholomew, many supernatural creatures do it as a form of self-defence.’

—Rivers of London

Siphōnem

Prerequisite: none.

Used to disarm a **Demon Trap** (page 324). Each stage of the spell has to be carefully worked so as not to trigger the trap, after which the magical essence that powers the trap is released. As this power is released, some clue as to the nature of the trap's construction and the *signare* of its creator may be detected.

As a fifth order spell, *Siphōnem* costs 5 magic points to cast. If cast successfully, it disarms a standard demon trap. Disarming a greater demon trap is more challenging, and requires the practitioner to achieve a Hard success on the casting roll.

Failing the casting roll activates a trigger on the demon trap (**Disarming a Demon Trap**, page 326).

To do siphōnem you have to run through each of the formae in turn, in the right sequence and with the right modifications. And you have to do this faster than the demon trap can release its magical payload.

—False Value

Vultus Occulto

Prerequisite: Shield (mastered).

An illusion spell that disguises a person, so that their face is hard to see—almost as if the person has no face at all. The spell lasts for 10 minutes. A determined magician can see through the illusion by spending a whole round staring at the caster and making a successful Magic roll.

Boost: each additional magic point spent increases the duration by 10 minutes.

I still couldn't see his face, but I'd done a bit of reading since Alexander Smith had given us the description of his face or, more accurately, hadn't. Victor Bartholomew, possibly the most boring magician that ever lived, named it as Vultus occulto, which even I knew was pig Latin, and had devoted an entire chapter on the subject of countermeasures which, typically for Bartholomew, I could boil down to one sentence: Keep looking really hard and sooner or later you'll see through it. So that's what I did.

—Moon Over Soho



SIXTH ORDER SPELLS

Heart Stop

Prerequisite: *Impello* (mastered).

At best, a temporary paralysis spell. At worst, the caster can cause the target's heart to stop beating, which is, by all accounts, a very difficult thing to achieve. Following a successful spellcasting roll, the caster must win an opposed roll with the target, with the caster pitting their POW against the target's CON.

The number of magic points spent determines the amount of damage inflicted. If the target fails the opposed roll, the spell's effect lasts as long as the caster maintains their concentration or 5 minutes, whichever occurs first. Due to the complexity and degree of control needed to cast this spell, it can only ever be directed against a single target. As a sixth order spell, Heart Stop costs 6 magic points and, at this level, inflicts 3 damage if the target loses the opposed roll, immediately marking them as Down (**Wounds and Healing**, page 144). Cast at this level, the damage presents as temporary paralysis.

If cast against an investigator, they have the option of spending Luck to win the opposed CON vs POW roll

(**Spending Luck**, page 113), or to buy off the effects of a mortal wound or survive a fatal blow (**Wounds and Healing**, page 144).

Boost: by increasing the magic point spend, the effect can be increased:

- ♦ **+1 magic point** (total cost of 7 magic points): inflicts 4 damage in a single blow (i.e., a **Mortal Wound**, page 146) if the target loses the opposed roll. Cast at this level, the damage presents as a severe angina attack or a mild heart attack.
- ♦ **+2 magic points** (total cost of 8 magic points): inflicts 5 damage in a single attack (i.e., a fatal blow; **Damage Conditions**, page 133) if the target loses the opposed roll. Cast at this level, the spell presents as a severe heart attack.

Human beings are really difficult to directly control by magic—Dr Walid has postulated that the human central nervous system generates its own autonomic magical resistance as a function of evolving in a world where potential predators can do magic. In order to partially paralyse me like that, Mrs Chin had to be a very highly trained practitioner. A true master, in Nightingale's terms. An utter pain in the arse, literally, in mine.

—False Value



Vox Imperante

Prerequisite: *Seducere*.

Issues a short, sharp command (no more than three words in length) that causes one or more targets to immediately stop what they are doing and obey the caster's command without thinking. The caster must be able to see the target(s) and the target(s) must be able to hear the caster for this spell to work. With this spell, the caster could command the target(s) to:

- ♦ "Stop!"
- ♦ "Drop it!"
- ♦ "Sit!"
- ♦ "Kill them!"
- ♦ "Go away!"
- ♦ "Open the door!"
- ♦ "Get me... [something/someone]!"

While similar to *Seducere*, *Vox imperante* enables the caster to affect groups of animals and people. It is also harder to correctly cast as it is usually only deployed in an emergency and at speed. The spell costs 6 magic points and can affect up to four targets (people and/or animals). When targeted at named NPCs or player characters, those characters make a POW roll to resist its effects, while non-named NPCs and animals are automatically affected.

If targeting a non-practitioner who is a named character or investigator, the outcomes of the POW roll to resist the spell are as follows:

- ♦ **Fumble or failure:** they do as they are bid without question, nor do they ever think to question why they acted as they did.
- ♦ **Regular or Hard success:** they do as they are bid without question, but later they perhaps wonder what possessed them to act the way they did. Of course, they soon console themselves with any excuse that feels rational to them.
- ♦ **Critical success:** they are unaffected by the spell and react to the request as though asked by another person. They are not aware of anything magical having taken place.

Whereas, if targeting a practitioner who is a named character or investigator, the outcomes of the POW roll to resist the spell are as follows:

- ♦ **Fumble:** they behave exactly as bidden. They are unaware of the use of the spell.
- ♦ **Failure:** they begin to act as requested, but then recover their self-control. They are aware of the use of the spell.
- ♦ **Any level of success:** they are aware of the use of *Vox imperante* but are not compelled to act upon it.

Boost: by increasing the magic point spend, the effect can be increased:

- ♦ **+1 magic point** (total cost of 7 magic points): extends the effect to groups of eight targets.
- ♦ **+2 magic points** (total cost of 8 magic points): extends the effect to groups of 16 targets.
- ♦ **+3 magic points** (total cost of 9 magic points): extends the effect to groups of 32 targets.

There's a spell called Vox imperante. To do it you've got to string together six forma and a dozen inflectores with absolute precision.
—Cry Fox

GM ADVICE

The phrase "named NPC" is used to refer to key non-player characters in the game, such as the characters described in **Chapter 6: A Rogues' Gallery**; this also includes key antagonists you create for your case files.



GM ADVICE

As with *Seducere* (page 190), if an investigator is the target of the spell, they can spend Luck to overcome a failed POW roll (**Spending Luck**, page 113). The player could also choose to push the roll—represented by them struggling to maintain their self-control and resist the command—though a second failure would leave the investigator completely at the caster's mercy.

